INCH-POUND

A-A-55214
July 12, 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

PILLOWCASE, COTTON AND POLYESTER/COTTON

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description in preference to Federal Specification DDD-P-351.

Abstract. This Commercial Item Description covers the requirements for cotton and polyester/cotton pillowcases intended for use by the military services and non-military agencies of the Federal Government.

Classification. The pillowcase shall be in the following types and classes:

Type		Class
I	Cotton	1 (140 count) 2 (140 count) 3 (140 count) 4 (140 count) 5 (180 count)
III	Polyester-cotton (65/35)-Commercial designation No 180 (percale)	1

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Defense Personnel Support Center, Clothing and Textiles Directorate, Attn: DPSC-FSSD, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101-8419, by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 7210

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Type		Class
IV	Polyester-cotton (50/50)-Commercial designation No. 128 (muslin)	1 2 3 4 5
V	Polyester-cotton (50/50)-Commercial designation No. 180 (percale)	1 2
VI	Polyester-cotton (65/35)-Commercial designation No. 128 (muslin)	1 2 3

Salient Characteristics The pillowcase shall be made of one rectangular-shaped piece of plain-weave blend sheeting cloth, hemmed, bleached or dyed as specified, cotton or polyester/cotton, unshrunk, and shall conform to the requirements listed in Table I.

Table I. Test Requirements

Characteristic	Test Method	Requirement
Weight	ASTM D-3776	See Table II
Breaking Strength	ASTM D-5034 1/	See Table II
Ends/Picks per Inch	ASTM D-3775	See Table II
Colorfastness to:		
Laundering	AATCC 61 2/	Equal to Standard or Class 4
Crocking	AATCC 8	Min. 3.5
Shrinkage	AATCC 96 3/	3.0 Max. W or F

1/ Note same as ASTM D-1682 Method 16 as cited in A-A-50145
2/ Test No. 1A except temperature shall be 160°F (71°C)
3/ Test Conditions Vc; Tumble Dry (A)

The pillowcases shall be seamed and the seams shall be straight when pillowcases are laid flat.

Basic material. The basic material for the pillowcase shall be as follows:

Type I, Classes 1, 2, 3 and 4 pillowcases shall be made of carded, drawn or spun cotton, bleached or dyed as specified, and shall meet the requirements in Table II.

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Type I, class 5 pillowcases shall be made of carded, combed, drawn and spun cotton, bleached as specified, and shall meet the requirements in Table II.

Type III pillowcases shall be 65 ± 5% polyester and the remainder cotton, bleached, conforming to the requirements in Table II.

Types IV and V pillowcases shall be 50 ± 5% polyester and the remainder cotton, bleached as specified.

Type VI pillowcases shall be 65 ± 5% polyester and the remainder cotton, dyed, and conforming to the requirements in Table II.

Table II - Physical Requirements

	Type I	Type I	Type III	Type IV	Type V	Type V
	bleached or dyed	bleached	bleached	bleached	bleached	dyed
	Class 1, 2, 3, 4	Class 5	Class 1	Class 1-5	Class 1-2	Class 1-3
Weight (oz./ sq. yd)	4.2	3.5	3.5	3.5	3.5	3.5
Yarns/ In.	140	180	177	128	180	122
Min. No. End/In.	74	98	97	68	98	66
Min No. Picks/In.	69	82	80	60	82	56
Breaking Strength (lbs. min)						
Warp	60	65	60	55	65	50
Filling	60	65	60	55	65	50

A minus tolerance of 6 yarns/in. for the 122 and 128 count, 7 yarns/in. for the 140 count and 8 yarns/in. for the 180 count in either the warp or filling will be permitted provided there is a total of not less than 122, 128, 140, 180 yarns/in. respectively (warp and filling).

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Thread. Thread for all hemming and seaming shall be white or matchi (as specified), either cotton soft finish, machine thread, Ticket No 50 (40 tex, nominal), 3 ply; or cotton-covered polyester thread, Ticket No. 70 (33 tex, nominal), 2 ply; or polyester spun, Ticket No. 70 (30 tex, nominal), 2 or 3 ply. The color of the thread for the Type I pillowcases shall be the same as specified for the cloth employed for the pillowcases. The color of the thread for hemming Types III, IV, V, and VI pillowcases shall be shade Orange TL, C.A. 66076. The thread shall show "good" colorfastness to laundering, dry heat, and light in accordance with applicable AATCC test methods. All sewing shall be done with 10 to 16 stitches per inch.

Dimensions. The dimensions of the pillowcases (expressed in inches), after hemming, shall be as specified in Table III.

TABLE III. Dimensions 1/

Type and class	Hems		Pillow case after hemming	
	Width	Tolerance	Width	Length
Type I				
1	1	± 1/4	20-1/2	27-1/2
2	3	± 1/4	20-1/2	32-1/2
3	3	± 1/4	22-1/4	32-1/2
4	1	± 1/4	20-1/2	30-1/2
5	3	± 1/4	20-1/2	32-1/2
Type III				
1	1	± 1/4	20-1/2	30-1/2
Type IV				
1	1	± 1/4	20-1/2	30-1/2
2	3	± 1/4	20-1/2	32-1/2
3	1	± 1/4	20-1/2	32-1/2
4	1	± 1/4	20-1/2	27-1/2
5	1	± 1/4	22-1/4	32-1/2
Type V				
1	1	± 1/4	20-1/2	30-1/2
2	3	± 1/4	20-1/2	32-1/2
Type VI				
1	1	± 1/4	20-1/2	30-1/2
2	3	± 1/4	20-1/2	32-1/2
3	1	± 1/4	20-1/2	32-1/2

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1/ Finished tolerances for the width and length dimensions shall be ± 1/2 in each direction.

Hems. The hem shall be of uniform width as specified in Table III. The hem shall be produced by turning the edge of the material under 1/2 ± 1/4 inch, folding it back over the body of the material and stitching the turned and folded portion of the body of the material with one row of single-needle, straight-lock stitches at a minimum of 10 stitches/in.

Seams. When one or two selvages are seamed, a lock stitch or chain stitch shall be used. Stitching shall be 1/8 - 5/8 inch from the selvage edge. As an alternate, a 5/32 - 1/4 inch overedge stitch, or a lock stitch or chain stitch, 3/8 - 5/8 inch from the edge may be used. The pillowcases shall be seamed and the seams shall be straight when pillowcases are laid flat.

When one selvage and one nonselvage of material are joined, they shall be stitched with a 5/32 - 1/4 inch overedge, or a chain stitch 3/8 - 5/8 inch from the material edge.

A lock stitching, when not caught in other seams and stitches, shall be bartacked not less than 1/2 inch at seam ends and stitching. Thread breaks shall be secured by stitching the back of the break not less than 1/2 inch.

Label/marking. The marking shall be a heat transfer (decalcomania), with direct printing, stamping or stenciling. The print shall be well defined, clearly legible; and shall not show smearing, bleeding, or off-setting. Printing shall not show any strike-through to the outside of the cloth. Unless otherwise specified, the printing shall be black and the label cloth shall be white. The cloth shall be either undyed cotton or polyester, or a blend of undyed cotton and polyester.

Each pillowcase shall have the block letters "US" 1/2 ± 1/16 inch in height. Medical procurements shall have a caduceus 1-7/8 ± 1/8 inch in height centered between the black letters "U" and "S" 1/2 ± 1/16 inch in height in accordance with Type I of MS 16686.

Markings shall be done on the inside. As an alternate, the marking may be done with a sewn-in label. Markings shall show colorfastness to laundering, dry and wet heat, accelerated laundering, dry cleaning, and weathering (wool method) in accordance with applicable AATCC test methods.

Label/tag. Each pillowcase shall be individually bar-coded with the Type VIII, Class 17 label/tag of DDD-L-20. The label/tag bar code shall be located so that it is completely visible on the pillowcase and causes no damage to the pillowcase.

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Fiber identification. Each pillowcase shall be labeled for fiber content in accordance with the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act.

Workmanship. The finished pillowcases shall conform to the quality of product established by this document. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

Product Demonstration Model. When required, offerers shall submit samples of their intended production. The product demonstration model will consist of units independently developed. Product demonstration models will be analyzed and evaluated by the government. Evaluation criteria and basis for award are contained in the solicitation. Product demonstration models will be retained by the government. One (1) product demonstration model approved by DPSC under the resultant contract will serve as a manufacturing standard for the corresponding production items delivered under this contract. Offerers are advised that the product demonstration model does not relieve the successful offerer of his responsibility to perform in accordance with the Commercial Item Description specified above.

Regulatory Requirements. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practicable.

Quality Assurance

Certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards and quality assurance practices The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract. Reliance on contractor quality assurance systems shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of ensuring that all products or supplies submitted to the government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract.

Examination Pillowcase lots shall be inspected in accordance with "Sampling Procedure and Tables for Inspection by Attributes," ANSI/ASQC Z1.4, published by the American Society for Quality Control.

Visual Examination The pillowcases shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of pillowcases. The sample unit is one pillowcase. The inspection level shall be I and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.0.

Defects. The pillowcase shall be examined for the following defects: any hole, cut, tear or slash; any floats or skips; any slub, slug, gout, jerked-in filling, or slough off; any spot or stain (outside);

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color not as specified; open seam, or twisted, pleated or puckered seam; hem not as specified, or twisted, pleated or puckered hem; any mend, abrasion mark, or broken or missing yarn; wrong seam or stitch type, or seam allowance; wrong thread tension; inappropriate backstitching, or insufficient stitches per inch; marking omitted, illegible or not as specified; any strike-through on outside of the pillowcase; not made of one piece of material; label missing, incorrect, or illegible; bar-code label/tag omitted or not readable by scanner, Human-Readable Interpretation (HRI) omitted or illegible, bar-coded type not as specified, and code density not as specified; measurement of item not as specified.

Dimensional Examination. The finished pillowcases shall conform to the dimensions specified. Any dimension that is not within the established tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The sample unit shall be one pillowcase; the inspection level shall be S-3; and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.0.

Packaging Examination. The fully packaged shipping containers shall be examined in accordance with defects listed below. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.0.

EXAMINE	DEFECT
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, or method of application
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, improper taping, or inadequate stapling
Content	Number of items in container is more or less than required
	NSN shown on one or more items not as specified on shipping container

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EXAMINE	DEFECT
Palletization	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirements
	Pallet type not as specified
	Load not bonded as specified

PACKAGING

Overseas

Packaging. Each pillowcase shall be folded. Ninety-six pillowcases shall be placed in a plastic bag.

Packing Ninety-six pillowcases shall be packed in a fiberboard box conforming to style RSC-L, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

Palletization Boxes shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pall in accordance with load type Ia of MIL-STD-147 Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means C or D, or film bonding means F or G. Pallet pattern shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147.

Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

Domestic

Packaging, Packing, Palletization and Marking. Packaging, packing, palletization and marking shall be in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

Source of Government Documents. Copies of Military and Federal documents are available from:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Bldg 4D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

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Sources of Nongovernment Documents.

ANSI/ASQC Z1.4 - Sampling Procedures and Tables For Inspection By Attributes

(Applications for copies should be addressed to American National Standards Institute, 11 West 42nd Street, New York, NY 10036.)

ASTM Test Methods

(Applications for copies should be addressed to American Society For Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

AATCC Test Methods

(Applications for copies should be addressed to American Association of Textile Chemists and Colorists (AATCC), P.O Box 12215, Triangle Park, NC 27709-2215)

Custodians:
Army - GL
Navy - NU
Air Force - 99

Review Activities:
Army - MD
Navy - MS, SH
DLA - DM
Air Force - 45

User Activity:
Navy - MC

Civil Agency Coordinating Activity:
GSA - FSS

Preparing Activity:
DLA - CT

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I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1 DOCUMENT NUMBER A-A-55214	2 DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD) 93-07-12

3 DOCUMENT TITLE
PILLOWCASE, COTTON AND POLYESTER/COTTON

4 NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible Attach extra sheets as needed)*

5 REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a NAME (Last, First, Middle initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	c TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8 PREPARING ACTIVITY

a NAME Defense Personnel Support Center ATTN: DPSC-FSSD (12-3-D)	b TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (215)737-8105 (2) AUTOVON 444-8105
c ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) 2800 South 20th Street P. O. Box 8419 Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19101-8419	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340

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